CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 18

Corin *Thimble*

FIDDLER AND LEADER OF THE BALL'S BAND

"From the musicians' balcony you see the whole ballroom. Almost."



FOR CORIN THIMBLE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 9+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A waistcoat or vest, a bow tie made of ribbon and a toy violin (or a ruler for a bow).

Mask: a black-and-white piano-key mask drawn on card.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper told the band last month that the museum would have "recorded music only."

YOUR SECRET

You have been offered a recording contract in the city and plan to leave the Hollow next month. You were going to tell everyone after the ball.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone on the musicians' balcony, tuning up and rehearsing the parade march. From up there you could see the stage line-up the whole time.

YOUR GOALS

- Confirm who stood in the line-up.
- Keep your city plans quiet until Round 3.
- Get the room to hum the Candlewick march.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

From the musicians' balcony you could see the stage all through the line-up rehearsal. You were alone up there from 8:20 to 8:50. Vesper told the band last month that the museum would have "recorded music only."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "How many hems did you pin tonight?"

? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Did you see the Lantern Ghost from outside?"

YOUR TASK

> Hum or whistle a tune, and see who joins in.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confirm what you saw from the balcony: Darcy and Briar never left the stage line between 8:30 and 8:45. You could not see the Lantern Gallery from the balcony; its doors were shut.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Why was the gallery door closed while you were in there?"

? Ask **Bexley Applegate:** "Did Vesper drink from the urn or the gallery kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who was NOT in the ballroom between 8:30 and 8:45.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the city recording contract. You would never have hurt Vesper: you were leaving anyway. Then add that at 8:48 you saw the lantern glide past the windows dead straight, like a bead on a string.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Is your fox mask the only one at the ball?"

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you hear the band down in the Dipping Room?"

YOUR TASK

> Vote for Best Costume before you vote on the murder.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade